for the centrality of nonviolence in the anticolonial movement', and this is all because of 'the influence and determination of one extraordinary individual: Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi'.[13]

What this overlooks is that Gandhi's philosophy of non-violence was indicative of a political frailty on his part. In *The Impossible Indian*, Faisal Devji explains that 'Gandhi confessed many times during this period to his realisation that the non-violence adopted by the Congress in the past had been born of weakness not strength . . .'. In fact, it was utterly ineffectual because 'it was merely passive resistance and had no transformative effect'. Worse, it was counter-productive. In an interview to Reuters on 5 May 1947, Gandhi himself admitted that 'the lack of an armed struggle against the British had prevented the development of a single nationality among Indians'. Was Bhagat Singh not then truer to the cause of Indian Independence than Gandhi? Was it not better to jointly fight the invader than fight each other? The question needs posing because as Devji goes on to say of Gandhi, 'He held that passive resistance was merely the preparation for an armed struggle.' But if this is so then he was surely far behind Bhagat Singh, who was already advocating armed resistance and was doing so from a position of moral strength of the kind that Gandhi had abandoned after the Chauri Chaura incident. Devji himself in his masterly study is no less sparing of Gandhi when he considers the legacy left behind by Gandhism because 'it was perhaps due to their consciousness of this cowardly and perverted exercise of nonviolence that so many Indians now turned with redoubled violence against their neighbors, since they had after all failed to engage the colonial state by force of arms'.

In the end, the tragedy of India was that 'though the British could be met with what Gandhi called the nonviolence of the weak, this was not possible in the far more intimate relations subsisting between Hindus and Muslims, where only the non-violence of the strong was possible'.[14] In a sense, therefore, Gandhism hurt not only the Independence struggle but hurt the very people of India itself, pitching Muslims against Hindus and Sikhs and making communal life impossible. By contrast, Bhagat Singh offered armed